

Bug Report: Invalid Booking Dates

Accepted

Metadata

(**Environment:** Production / Sandbox (<https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com>) •
Endpoint: POST /booking •
Severity: Medium / Major •
Module: Booking Management •

Description .1

The validation system in the booking creation endpoint (POST /booking) is insufficiently strict, allowing users to successfully register a booking where the check-out date (checkout) is earlier than the check-in date (checkin). This is a business logic flaw, as a stay cannot logically end before it begins

Steps to Reproduce .2

- .Open Postman .1
- .Set the HTTP method to **POST** and the request URL to {{baseUrl}}/booking .2
- :Add the following headers .3
 - Content-Type: application/json ○
 - Accept: application/json ○
- .(Provide a request body with reversed/invalid dates (see Request section below) .4
- .Click **Send** .5

Request Details .3

Method: POST •
URL: <https://restful-booker.herokuapp.com/booking> •
Headers: •
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json

Body (JSON): •
{
 "firstname": "Edge",
 "lastname": "Case",
 "totalprice": 200,
 "depositpaid": true,
 "bookingdates": {

```
"checkin": "2026-06-10",
"checkout": "2026-06-01"
},
"additionalneeds": "None"
{
```

Response Details .4

(**Status Code:** 200 OK (Expected a validation error) •

Response Body: •

```
{
  "bookingid": 3412,
  "booking": {
    "firstname": "Edge",
    "lastname": "Case",
    "totalprice": 200,
    "depositpaid": true,
    "bookingdates": {
      "checkin": "2026-06-10",
      "checkout": "2026-06-01"
    },
    "additionalneeds": "None"
  }
}
```

Actual vs Expected Result .5

Actual Result: The server accepted the request, returned a **200 OK** status code, and •
.successfully generated a valid bookingid for the conflicting dates

Expected Result: The server should reject the request and return a **400 Bad Request** •
.validation error with a descriptive error message regarding the invalid date range